INFORMATION TO KEEP WITH YOU

My complete treatment handbook

Goserelin 10.8 mg: hormone implant every 12 weeks

Understand your treatment. Know what to expect. Keep your plan to hand.

Displayed calendar
84 days
See the active treatment phase

Treatment stages
1
Explained in the treatment reference

Regimen source
NCCP 00477
Version 3

One implant every 12 weeks

Treatment stages

01 **Long-acting hormone treatment**
One implant every 12 weeks

Your team confirms the active stage and dates. The full treatment guide explains each step.

Inside your handbook

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My name _____

Hospital / oncology team _____

Use the urgent instructions and contact numbers in your treatment guide. Your team must replace example numbers before patient use. Your individual treatment plan takes precedence.

CHAPTER 01

Understanding your treatment

IN THIS CHAPTER

Why this treatment is offered, what its medicines do, and how the agreed plan fits your care.

Goserelin 10.8 mg: hormone implant every 12 weeks
National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00477

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Call your team promptly for new or worsening symptoms, severe low mood or problems taking treatment. New leg weakness, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure needs emergency assessment: call 112/999.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

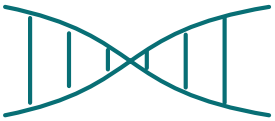
How this hormone treatment works

This is androgen deprivation therapy (ADT): it lowers testosterone to help control prostate cancer. With radiotherapy, the aim may be cure; in advanced disease, it is part of ongoing cancer control.

GNRH AGONIST

Goserelin 10.8 mg

Zoladex LA



Switches down the testosterone signal after an initial rise

Goserelin is a GnRH agonist. It first stimulates the pituitary, which may briefly increase testosterone. With continued exposure the pituitary becomes less responsive and testosterone falls. Your team assesses the need for temporary anti-androgen protection against this initial flare.

Brief initial stimulation → Pituitary response reduces → Testosterone falls

What to watch for

Tell the team if you take blood-thinning medicines or are very thin. These can increase bleeding risk at implantation. Severe abdominal pain, marked swelling, dizziness or collapse afterwards needs urgent help. Do not stop blood thinners yourself.

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

What the evidence can tell you

Trials support the discussion but do not predict an individual outcome.

Goserelin is an established way to lower testosterone. The clinical benefit depends on the cancer setting and whether other treatments are added. A testosterone or PSA response is not a personalised survival estimate, and this depot should not be ranked against other ADT choices using unrelated trials.

CHAPTER 02

Your schedule, tests and appointments

IN THIS CHAPTER

Your treatment stages, checks and practical preparations, from before treatment through follow-up.

Your treatment course

Goserelin 10.8 mg: hormone implant every 12 weeks

84-day view



This shows treatment timing, not guaranteed symptom-free days. Your team confirms the active phase and dates.

ONE IMPLANT EVERY 12 WEEKS

Long-acting hormone treatment

Duration set by your treatment plan

Goserelin 10.8 mg is placed under the skin of the front of the abdomen every 12 weeks (84 days). Your team writes the next date and the intended treatment duration.

Androgen deprivation therapy (ADT) lowers testosterone, a hormone that can drive prostate cancer. This medicine is your ADT. Additional cancer tablets, chemotherapy or radiotherapy are separate decisions based on your cancer and overall health. Keep treatment going until your team changes the plan; do not stop because prostate-specific antigen (PSA) has fallen.

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Your tests and treatment checks

Safety and response tests have different purposes. Use the individual prescription and appointment dates.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00477 v3: official regimen · Zoladex LA: product information

Tests in your plan

Blood count, kidney and liver tests

WHEN

Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile. NCCP does not specify one interval for these tests. Review symptoms, PSA and testosterone, with scans according to the individual plan.

Checks blood cells and organ health.

Blood glucose and bone blood profile

WHEN

Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile. NCCP does not specify one interval for these tests. Review symptoms, PSA and testosterone, with scans according to the individual plan.

Checks metabolic effects and blood minerals.

PSA and testosterone

If part of your plan

WHEN

Prostate-specific antigen (PSA) helps assess cancer activity. Testosterone checks the effect of hormone suppression, especially if response is uncertain. Your team interprets these with symptoms and scans.

Checks cancer activity and hormone suppression.

ECG and bone-density assessment

If part of your plan

WHEN

ECG (heart tracing) and bone-density scans are arranged according to heart-rhythm risk, fracture risk and clinical need. Your team confirms which tests you need.

Checks heart rhythm or fracture risk when indicated.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Goserelin 10.8 mg: hormone implant every 12 weeks: treatment and checks

Locally advanced or metastatic hormone-sensitive prostate cancer under NCCP 00477.

Goserelin 10.8 mg is placed under the skin of the front of the abdomen every 12 weeks (84 days). Your team writes the next date and the intended treatment duration.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	Between appointments	Next review	Longer-term care
Blood and organ safety NCCP · SMPC	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and a bone blood profile. Review heart disease, blood pressure, diabetes, mood, falls and fracture risk, sexual health, medicines and the treatment goal.	Confirm baseline results and the starting plan.	Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile. NCCP does not specify one interval for these tests. Review symptoms, PSA and testosterone, with scans according to the individual plan.	Confirm results and symptoms before the next prescription or injection.	Review bone, metabolic and heart health.

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	Between appointments	Next review	Longer-term care
Treatment and appointments NCCP · SMPC	Agree treatment aim, formulation, duration and medicines list.	A trained healthcare professional places the implant under the skin of the front of the abdomen. This 10.8 mg implant has a different schedule from the 3.6 mg formulation; do not swap strengths or appointment intervals.	Keep an accurate medicine / injection record.	Tell the team if you take blood-thinning medicines or are very thin. These can increase bleeding risk at implantation. Severe abdominal pain, marked swelling, dizziness or collapse afterwards needs urgent help. Do not stop blood thinners yourself.	Continue until the team changes the plan.
Cancer response NCCP · SMPC	Prostate-specific antigen (PSA) helps assess cancer activity. Testosterone checks the effect of hormone suppression, especially if response is uncertain. Your team interprets these with symptoms and scans.	Document the baseline PSA and clinical picture.	Ask when the next PSA and any testosterone test are due.	Review symptoms and results together.	Scans follow the individual plan; there is no universal interval.

What each check is for

1



Treatment and review

One implant every 12 weeks

This is androgen deprivation therapy (ADT): it lowers testosterone to help control prostate cancer. With radiotherapy, the aim may be cure; in advanced disease, it is part of ongoing cancer control.

Ask / **act:** Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile. NCCP does not specify one interval for these tests. Review symptoms, PSA and testosterone, with scans according to the individual plan.

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.



STEP 1

Before starting

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and a bone blood profile. Review heart disease, blood pressure, diabetes, mood, falls and fracture risk, sexual health, medicines and the treatment goal.



STEP 2

Taking or receiving treatment

A trained healthcare professional places the implant under the skin of the front of the abdomen. This 10.8 mg implant has a different schedule from the 3.6 mg formulation; do not swap strengths or appointment intervals.



STEP 3

Tests and reviews

Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile. NCCP does not specify one interval for these tests. Review symptoms, PSA and testosterone, with scans according to the individual plan.

STEP 5

Leaving with a clear plan

Confirm the exact next dose or appointment, duration and verified daytime and out-of-hours contacts.

Your exact treatment schedule

Tests and preparation

PSA and testosterone

Prostate-specific antigen (PSA) helps assess cancer activity. Testosterone checks the effect of hormone suppression, especially if response is uncertain. Your team interprets these with symptoms and scans.

CHAPTER 03

Symptoms and supportive care

IN THIS CHAPTER

Recognising changes, knowing when to call, and using your prescribed supportive-care plan.

Your 12-week injection interval

One injection or implant at the start. The medicine continues working between visits.

Treatment or check	Timing in this view
Injection / implant	**Week 1** Day 1
Continuous hormone suppression	**Week 1 → Week 2 → Week 3 → Week 4 → Week 5 → Week 6 → Week 7 → Week 8 → Week 9 → Week 10 → Week 11 → Week 12** Depot works throughout all 12 weeks

Prescribed schedule: Goserelin 10.8 mg is placed under the skin of the front of the abdomen every 12 weeks (84 days). Your team writes the next date and the intended treatment duration.

How this fits: Androgen deprivation therapy (ADT) lowers testosterone, a hormone that can drive prostate cancer. This medicine is your ADT. Additional cancer tablets, chemotherapy or radiotherapy are separate decisions based on your cancer and overall health. Keep treatment going until your team changes the plan; do not stop because prostate-specific antigen (PSA) has fallen.

Early safety: Tell the team if you take blood-thinning medicines or are very thin. These can increase bleeding risk at implantation. Severe abdominal pain, marked swelling, dizziness or collapse afterwards needs urgent help. Do not stop blood thinners yourself.

> The next dose is due 84 days after the previous dose unless the team changes the plan. Twelve weeks is not always the same date as three calendar months. Use the written appointment date.

Between-treatment notes

Day 1: Treatment visit

A trained healthcare professional places the implant under the skin of the front of the abdomen. This 10.8 mg implant has a different schedule from the 3.6 mg formulation; do not swap strengths or appointment intervals. Goserelin 10.8 mg is placed under the skin of the front of the abdomen every 12 weeks (84 days). Your team writes the next date and the intended treatment duration.

Day 2–84: Between appointments

The depot continues working between injections. Symptoms can occur on any day. Keep your next booked appointment; contact the team promptly if it is missed.

Support around the medicines

1 Sickness support

This treatment has minimal sickness risk. Routine preventive anti-sickness medicines are not usually required; agree a plan if symptoms develop.

2 **Bone and muscle health**

Discuss fracture risk, bone-density testing when indicated, calcium intake, vitamin D and suitable resistance and aerobic exercise. Supplements and bone medicines are individual decisions.

3 **Sexual health, mood and hot flushes**

Tell the team which effects matter most. Support is available for sexual function, sleep, mood and vasomotor symptoms.

4 **Medicine review**

Bring all prescriptions, over-the-counter medicines and supplements. Ask pharmacy before starting or stopping anything.

Why hormone treatment is used

Treatment goals and choices

Additional treatment

In metastatic hormone-sensitive cancer, many suitable patients benefit from an additional androgen-pathway medicine, and sometimes chemotherapy. Radiotherapy can have a different role in localised disease, selected metastatic disease or symptom relief. Your specialist explains the options for your setting.

Deciding together

Discuss expected benefit, uncertainty, side effects, alternatives including surgical castration where appropriate, and the option of declining treatment. No one duration fits every setting.

Questions worth asking

Do I need another cancer medicine or radiotherapy alongside this?

Ask how this hormone treatment fits the plan for your disease. Additional hormone-pathway medicines, chemotherapy and radiotherapy have different roles; they are not automatically needed in every setting.

How can we protect bone, heart, sexual and mental health?

Ask for a plan covering exercise, bone and fracture risk, blood pressure and glucose, sexual symptoms, mood and sleep. Tell the team about changes early so support can be offered.

Who can I contact urgently?

Use the verified daytime and out-of-hours numbers supplied by your treating hospital. For severe breathing difficulty, collapse, a seizure or severe chest pain, call 112 or 999. Do not use the example numbers in this draft.

Try explaining the plan back: Explain your starting dose and usual schedule. Explain what to do after a missed dose or appointment. Name your next tests and your urgent contact route.

Supportive prescription draft for review. This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

One implant every 12 weeks

Active medicines: Goserelin 10.8 mg

Emetogenic risk: Minimal

No routine prophylactic antiemetic order. Agree symptom treatment if needed.

Additional phase-specific support

- A trained healthcare professional places the implant under the skin of the front of the abdomen. This 10.8 mg implant has a different schedule from the 3.6 mg formulation; do not swap strengths or appointment intervals.
- Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile. NCCP does not specify one interval for these tests. Review symptoms, PSA and testosterone, with scans according to the individual plan.
- Tell the team if you take blood-thinning medicines or are very thin. These can increase bleeding risk at implantation. Severe abdominal pain, marked swelling, dizziness or collapse afterwards needs urgent help. Do not stop blood thinners yourself.
- Bone health, calcium and vitamin D according to individual needs and local policy.

Before signing: verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

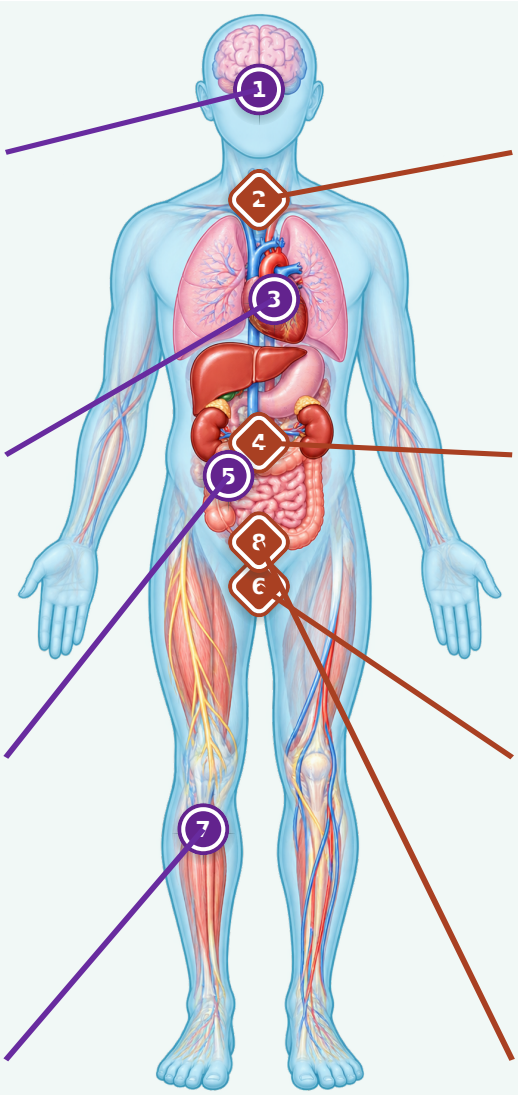
Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Mood, sleep and energy
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Report severe low mood, marked fatigue or sleep problems. Ask for support early.

2 Hot flushes and sweating
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Hormone suppression can cause hot flushes. Ask about practical measures and treatments if troublesome.



3 Heart and blood pressure
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Keep planned checks. Chest pain, fainting or severe breathlessness needs urgent assessment.

4 Weight and blood sugar
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Blood glucose, weight and cardiovascular risk need review; suitable activity and diet can help.

5 Injection or implant site
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Report severe abdominal pain, swelling or dizziness after the implant.

6 Sexual health and fertility
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Reduced desire and erection difficulties are common. Discuss fertility and contraception; ADT is not reliable contraception.

7 Bones and muscles
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Ask about bone assessment, resistance exercise, falls prevention, calcium intake and vitamin D needs.

8 Urine and early symptoms
Goserelin 10.8 mg
Report difficulty passing urine or worsening pain. New leg weakness or loss of bladder/ bowel control is an emergency.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call your team promptly for new or worsening symptoms, severe low mood or problems taking treatment. New leg weakness, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure needs emergency assessment: call 112/999.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

CHAPTER 04

Sources and further information

IN THIS CHAPTER

The references behind this information and addresses you can use to find further help.

Use this information alongside the plan agreed with your treatment team. Your team confirms your medicines, doses and appointments.

1. **NCCP regimen-specific supportive care**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6978/477_v3_Goserelin_10.8mg.pdf
2. **Zoladex LA: product information**
   https://assets.hpra.ie/products/Human/23462/Licence_PA1019-027-002_30062026120416.pdf
3. **HSE: cancer treatment side effects**
   https://www.hse.ie/conditions/cancer/if-you-have-side-effects/
4. **NCCP supportive-care antiemetics for NCIS**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/7180/Supportive_Care_Antiemetics_for_inclusion_NCIS_Medical_Oncology.pdf
5. **NCI: hormone therapy for prostate cancer**
   https://www.cancer.gov/types/prostate/prostate-hormone-therapy-fact-sheet